

Apple September 2026 Event — Product Briefing

Reference note compiled 9 September 2026. Specifications, prices and dates are drawn from MacRumors' live coverage of the event at macrumors.com; the wording and organisation of this document are original. Prepared as sample knowledge-base content for the offline agent runtime.

1. Event overview

Apple ran a 77-minute product presentation on 9 September 2026 under the banner “Surprise and Shine”. The event was notable for a leadership change as much as for hardware: John Ternus appeared as chief executive, with Tim Cook handing over the role. Four product lines were updated — the iPhone Pro family, a new foldable iPhone, AirPods, and Apple Watch — and the connecting theme across all of them was on-device artificial intelligence. Apple positioned Apple Intelligence as the reason each product needed new silicon, rather than presenting AI as a separate software story.

2. iPhone 18 Pro and iPhone 18 Pro Max

The iPhone 18 Pro and 18 Pro Max are built around the A20 Pro, Apple's first chip on a 2-nanometre process. The headline camera change is a variable aperture on the 48-megapixel fusion main camera, implemented with laser-cut blades, which gives photographers direct control over depth of field rather than simulating it in software.

Alongside the camera hardware, Apple introduced Apple Reference Image, an authentication feature that verifies a photograph at the pixel level. The intent is provenance: establishing that an image came from the camera and has not been altered, which matters increasingly as generated imagery becomes indistinguishable from captured imagery.

Battery figures quoted were up to 24 hours of typical use on the Pro and up to 30 hours on the Pro Max. For video playback specifically, Apple cited 36 hours on the Pro and 45 hours on the Pro Max. Fast charging reaches roughly 50 percent in about 15 minutes. Four finishes were shown: deep black, refined silver, glacier blue, and burgundy.

Pricing starts at \$1,199 for the iPhone 18 Pro with 256GB of storage, and \$1,299 for the iPhone 18 Pro Max. Pre-orders open on 12 September 2026, with general availability on 18 September 2026.

3. iPhone Duo (foldable)

The iPhone Duo is Apple's first foldable iPhone. It pairs a 7.6-inch inner display — about 50 percent larger in area than the Pro Max screen — with a 5.4-inch outer display that covers roughly 90 percent of the area of a standard Pro screen. The intent is that the closed device is a fully usable phone rather than a compromised cover screen.

Construction is a titanium frame housing two batteries that the system presents and manages as a single cell. Apple quoted up to 24 hours of all-day balanced use, with video playback of 31 hours on the inner display and 44 hours on the outer. The display carries a custom nano-texture finish to cut glare, which is a particular problem on a large folding panel.

Cameras include the same variable-aperture main camera as the Pro line plus a 48-megapixel ultrawide. On the software side, iOS was reworked for the form factor: the dock becomes vertical and controls shift to the side of the screen when unfolded, and Apple demonstrated redesigned first-party apps that use the dual-screen layout rather than simply scaling up.

The iPhone Duo starts at \$1,999 for 256GB, with configurations running up to 2TB. Two colours were shown, Star White and Night Sky. It follows a later schedule than the Pro models: pre-orders on 16 October 2026 and availability on 23 October 2026.

4. AirPods 5

AirPods 5 ship in two variants at different price points. The standard model is \$129 and rated for more than four hours of listening with active noise cancellation engaged, or about 20 hours in total with the case. The premium model is \$149 and adds roughly five hours of ANC listening, volume control on the stem, and a wireless charging case.

Both models get improved noise cancellation and better durability, and both support Hey Siri and Live Translation. AirPods 5 go on sale 18 September 2026, the same day as the iPhone 18 Pro line.

5. Apple Watch Series 12 and Ultra 4

Both watches move to the S11 chip, which Apple credits for a set of features it groups as Audio Intelligence. These include sound recognition that can raise alerts and notifications based on ambient audio, and Siri Recap, which produces summaries of meetings from the wrist.

The larger change is health sensing. A revised sensor system samples heart rate up to 60 times more frequently than the previous generation, feeding a redesigned Health app organised around longevity. That app introduces a Health Age metric, which combines signals into a single figure intended to be tracked over time rather than read as a clinical result.

Durability improves as well: Ceramic Shield screens on the aluminium cases are described as 60 percent tougher. Series 12 starts at \$399 and Ultra 4 at \$799. Battery expectations differ by tier — Series 12 targets a standard day of use, while Ultra 4 targets two days. Both are available 18 September 2026.

6. Software and Apple Intelligence

Apple Intelligence ran through the whole presentation rather than occupying a segment of it. The architecture Apple described splits work between on-device models and Private Cloud Compute, which handles requests too large for the device while keeping the data outside Apple's ordinary server logging. Siri was presented as more contextually aware, able to act on what is currently on screen and in recent activity.

New iOS 27 features were demonstrated throughout, with the most substantial work being the app redesigns required by the iPhone Duo's two screens and its fold-state transitions.

7. Price summary

Product	Starting price	Pre-order	Available
iPhone 18 Pro (256GB)	\$1,199	12 Sep 2026	18 Sep 2026
iPhone 18 Pro Max	\$1,299	12 Sep 2026	18 Sep 2026
iPhone Duo (256GB)	\$1,999	16 Oct 2026	23 Oct 2026
AirPods 5 (standard)	\$129	—	18 Sep 2026
AirPods 5 (premium)	\$149	—	18 Sep 2026
Apple Watch Series 12	\$399	—	18 Sep 2026
Apple Watch Ultra 4	\$799	—	18 Sep 2026

8. Release calendar

Two waves of availability were announced. The first wave lands on 18 September 2026 and covers the iPhone 18 Pro, iPhone 18 Pro Max, both AirPods 5 models, Apple Watch Series 12 and Apple Watch Ultra 4, with iPhone pre-orders opening six days earlier on 12 September. The second wave is the iPhone Duo alone, pre-ordering on 16 October and shipping on 23 October 2026 — a five-week gap that reflects the foldable being a genuinely new manufacturing problem rather than an annual refresh.